

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023-24



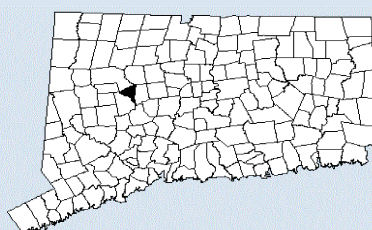
Thomaston School District

Francine Coss, Superintendent • 860-283-3053 x2 • <http://www.thomastonschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	4
Enrollment	776
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,926
Total Expenditures ¹	\$18,431,986

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	381	49.1	48.3
Male	395	50.9	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.2
Asian	15	1.9	5.2
Black or African American	14	1.8	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	82	10.6	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	27	3.5	4.7
White	638	82.2	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	14	1.8	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	297	38.3	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	114	14.7	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	42	11.8	9	2.3
Male	57	15.4	46	11.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	19	25.3	9	9.8
White	71	11.9	39	5.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	63	22.6	38	11.4
Students with Disabilities	25	24.0	15	10.8
District	99	13.6	55	6.8
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 82

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	54.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	5.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	12.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	14.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	3.5
School Level	4.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	4.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	5.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	7.0
School Nurses	3.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	42.7

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	1.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	89	98.9	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.7	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	0	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	0	*
White	37	100.0	43	95.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	10	*	18	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*	*	*
District	44	100.0	45	95.7
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	6	*
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	49	86.0
Other Health Impairment	6	*
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	12	*
District	78	72.2
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	14	1.7	2.6
Emotional Disability	10	1.2	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	57	6.9	6.4
Other Health Impairment	*	*	3.5
Other Disabilities	7	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	15	1.8	2.0
All Disabilities	113	13.7	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$10,688,595	\$11,555	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$1,358,129	\$1,664	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$294,897	\$361	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,111,134	\$1,362	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$1,120,923	\$1,374	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$423,146	\$519	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$2,055,194	\$2,519	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$1,042,361	\$1,124	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$337,607	\$414	\$213
Total	\$18,431,986	\$19,926	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,397,229	31.6	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$408,396	9.2	10.2
Other Salaries	\$250,460	5.7	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$454,135	10.3	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$598,172	13.5	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$925,604	20.9	22.2
Supplies	\$94,577	2.1	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$276,595	6.3	8.4
Equipment	\$5,940	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$7,600	0.2	0.1
Total	\$4,418,708	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	60.6
State	33.8
Federal	5.3
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	8	*	8	*	6	*
Black or African American	7	*	7	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	44	59.4	44	56.1	17	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	14	*	14	*	*	*
White	344	65.3	344	60.4	137	66.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	13	*	13	*	6	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	404	65.0	404	60.0	163	66.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	156	61.9	156	55.6	52	60.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	261	66.7	261	62.6	117	69.2
Students with Disabilities	63	47.6	63	41.5	21	51.8
Students without Disabilities	354	68.0	354	63.3	148	68.5
High Needs	190	60.4	190	54.5	65	60.1
Non-High Needs	227	68.7	227	64.6	104	70.3
District	417	64.9	417	60.0	169	66.4

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	91.4	85.5	89.7	85.7	232	88.4
Curl Up	81.4	82.3	69.0	83.3	232	78.9
Push Up	74.3	62.7	51.7	68.3	228	64.5
Mile Run/PACER	76.8	72.6	68.4	85.4	229	75.1
All Tests - District	56.5	42.4	42.1	55.0	225	48.9
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	6	*
White	52	96.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	25	88.0
Students with Disabilities	6	*
District	62	93.5
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	42	84.0
Male	20	48.8
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	0	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	*
White	59	72.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	14	48.3
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	62	68.1
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	71.4	89.3
Male	68.0	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	N/A	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	71.2	91.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	56.5	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	70.0	92.3
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	64.9	75	43.3	50	86.5	63.9
	High Needs Students	60.4	75	40.3	50	80.5	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	60.0	75	40.0	50	80.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	54.5	75	36.4	50	72.7	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	66.4	75	44.3	50	88.5	61.8
	High Needs Students	60.1	75	40.1	50	80.1	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	60.1%	100%	60.1	100	60.1	58.7%
	High Needs Students	65.1%	100%	65.1	100	65.1	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	62.3%	100%	62.3	100	62.3	61.4%
	High Needs Students	67.0%	100%	67.0	100	67.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	13.6%	<=5%	32.7	50	65.5	17.7%
	High Needs Students	21.7%	<=5%	16.7	50	33.4	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	97.8%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	68.1%	75%	45.4	50	90.8	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		98.2%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		93.5%	94%	99.5	100	99.5	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		92.0%	94%	97.9	100	97.9	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		70.0%	75%	93.3	100	93.3	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		94.9% 48.9%	75%	32.6	50	65.2	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		48.9%	60%	40.8	50	81.5	55.0%
Accountability Index				1057.7	1350	78.3	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	68.7	60.4	8.3	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	64.6	54.5	10.1	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	70.3	60.1	10.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	92.0%	2.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.8
	High Needs Students	98.0
Math	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	97.5
Science	All Students	96.6
	High Needs Students	93.0

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Thomaston's efforts to improve programs and services for all students have taken many successful forms: four full-day, tuition-free NAEYC Preschool classrooms, a therapeutic program located in each school and staffed with clinical support for K-12 students and families, and partnerships with Wellmore and Connecticut Junior Republic for crisis and preventative support. Co-teaching is utilized in K-12 along with Occupational Therapy, Physical Therapy and Speech/Language Therapy.

Teachers share pedagogy and practice regularly in order to ensure that all students are meeting performance expectations. Teacher teams provide support for struggling and high achieving students by implementing strategies, interventions, and enrichment activities through Interventionists and Instructional Coaches. The District's BCBA recommends behavioral interventions when applicable.

The District Attendance Review Board (DARB) is a collaborative approach to truancy prevention. Each school has an active DARB, comprised minimally of the principal, school counselor, and the school nurse. DARB communicates with parents regarding attendance concerns and provides outreach for students with low attendance. An active, Parent-Teacher Association is the foundation of this commitment. Teachers teamed with the PTA to engage parents in the planning and improvement of school programs. Annual climate surveys are offered to parents to solicit opinions on the climate and atmosphere of each school and to identify programs in need of improvement. Parent Square, school-parent communication app is used to communicate with parents, staff, students and Board of Education members.

Students participated in fun educational activities and parents were given tips on how to help their child with math and reading at home. These programs include: Open House, conferences, Socials, Book Fairs, Shows, school assemblies, and Haunted Hallways. Grade level teams distribute information to parents detailing school-related events and activities, as well as ways parents can work at home with their children on learning activities. Google Classroom pages and teacher webpages keep parents aware of happenings in their classrooms. All schools are committed to engaging families in student learning. To provide better accessibility and parent involvement in the decision making process, the option to participate virtually is available during Principal Advisory Council (PAC) meetings. PAC meets monthly with Principals to seek ways to continuously improve the educational process for students and families. Additionally, our principals send weekly notifications to parents with information from the school and various community organizations. Parents and students also have access to a private Facebook page and all students and parents have access to a public X ("Twitter") page which announces events and celebrates the work of students and staff. Thomaston High School offers unique support for parents through the Guidance Department's multiple scholarship connections which are shared with parents and students through the department's newsletter. Athletics at Thomaston High School also engaged parents and community members with multiple league and division championships drawing parents and the general public to competitions.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The full-day Preschool Program reduces economic isolation through tuition-free enrollment. While students can attend interdistrict magnet schools, those who remain in-district enjoy a variety of experiences designed to increase awareness of diversity. Our elementary teachers integrate cultural and ethnic awareness into the language arts, social studies, music and art curricula. Interdisciplinary lessons encourage students to understand and embrace cultural and ethnic differences. Students are exposed to literature that allow them to explore, in depth, a variety of cultural, ethnic and economic situations and conditions that are in contrast to their own. School counselors implement a district-developed, research-informed program that includes lessons based on thematic character pillars: cultural awareness, citizenship, responsibility and caring. Classroom and school-wide activities promote the growth of mutual respect, tolerance, and positive character. K-6 students participate in BEAR (Behaving Exceptionally And Responsibly), a program created by staff specifically designed to build a student's social- emotional skills and actively encourage acceptance of others. Students at Center School participate in Project Wisdom, a daily announcement program designed to promote making positive choices which are followed up with corresponding classroom lessons. Additionally, a student group representing all grade levels attends the Elementary Level Leadership Conference annually. High school students participate in a school-wide day of service where all students and staff volunteer and demonstrate civic responsibility.

Thomaston High School enhances cultural knowledge, instills a greater appreciation for diversity and embraces differences with the support of Advisory, Gay Straight Alliance, Beauty, Inside and Out, world language courses, and culturally themed events achieve this goal. Students interact with other schools through the Connecticut Youth Forum, Middle School Leadership Conference, and Middle School Writer's workshop.

Districtwide support staff developed a guide for families that includes resources for electricity, food, and housing assistance. This guide is shared through ParentSquare by school social workers and/or school counselors.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

District and school administrators and staff collaborate throughout the budget planning process as well as during biweekly Administrative Council meetings to be certain all resources are allocated equitably and shared across the district. This collaborative effort ensures that students' needs are addressed and that funds are allocated equitably across schools. Also, each year, the administration works collaboratively to share resources between and among buildings and departments. Professional workshops, materials, and staffing were shared across disciplines as well as between general education and special education students. Parents contributed to this collaborative effort through feedback collected in school climate surveys; parent-perceived inequities were included in the budget planning and resource sharing efforts. Further, in an effort to equitably represent the needs of each school to the community, a district-wide Parent Teacher Association provides resources to all schools in the district. Every student PK-12 is given a Chromebook.